

Daily Routine: Mad Scientist Mode (7 Weeks)

Rule: Sleep is non-negotiable. 12 hours of focused work is only sustainable with 8 hours of sleep and one walk per day.

(if i want to see in nice table view cmd+shift+v)

Schedule

Time	Activity	Guardrails
0600	Wake, coffee, 30 min reading	Read only: Nature / Molecular Therapy / Human Gene Therapy / ASGCT newsletter. No social media. No email.
0630	Deep Work Block 1 (3h)	Hardest task of the day. No phone. No Slack. No email. If stuck, write pseudocode or outline prose; do not switch tasks.
0930	Break	Walk outside. 10 min minimum. No screens.
1000	Deep Work Block 2 (3h)	Second-hardest task. Continue if in flow; switch to next scheduled task if first is complete.
1300	Lunch + 30 min break	Eat away from desk if possible. No work reading.
1400	Integration Block (2h)	Testing, debugging, writing transitions between sections, assembling figures. Lighter cognitive load.
1600	Coffee + 30 min break	No screens. Stretch.
1630	Integration Block 2 (2h)	Continue integration, or switch to next day's prep if ahead of schedule.
1830	Dinner break	Completely off. Social or solitary, but no work.
1930	Light Work Block (2h)	Documentation, citations, reading, tests, figure formatting. No hard debugging.
2130	Shutdown ritual (15-30 min)	Git commit everything. Write 3 specific objectives for tomorrow. Clear desk.
2200	Hard stop	Sleep.

Weekly Rhythm

Day	Focus
Monday	Hard architecture / new modules
Tuesday	Implementation / writing
Wednesday	Integration / validation
Thursday	Debugging / refinement

Day	Focus
Friday	Polish / tests / documentation
Saturday	Case study work / reading / lighter writing
Sunday	Paper writing / figure making / preparation for next week

There are no weekends off. But Saturday/Sunday are lighter cognitive load to prevent cumulative burnout.

Commit Rules

1. **Commit every evening at 2130 minimum.** Even if messy. Commit message must start with week-day code: “w1d1”, “w4d22”, etc.
2. **Push to remote (GitHub) every 3 days.** Do not risk losing work to disk failure.
3. **Tag at end of every week:** w1-complete, w2-complete, etc.
4. **Tag at milestones:** v0.1-PoC, v0.2-alpha, v1.0-submission

Environment Rules

- **One workspace only.** VS Code full-screen, terminal panel open, no other apps visible.
- **Phone:** in another room during deep work blocks. Use Forest app or screen-time lock if needed.
- **Email:** check once per day at 1930 during light work block. No exceptions.
- **Music:** instrumental only (classical, lo-fi, ambient). No lyrics.
- **Food:** prepare meals in advance twice per week. Do not waste decision-making energy on food during work hours.

Energy Management

Symptom	Action
Brain fog at 1000	You did not sleep enough. Do 10 burpees or a cold shower. If persists, take 20 min nap.
Stuck on bug for >45 min	Write problem description in a new file, switch tasks for 1 hour, return with fresh eyes.
Writing sounds stupid	Read it aloud. If still bad, sleep on it. Never discard text; move to paper/drafts/ for later mining.
No motivation	Re-read the Introduction draft. Remember the 6,000 diseases. You are the only one building this right now.
Headache	20 min walk. Water. Screen brightness down. If chronic: schedule eye exam.
Loneliness	This is normal for deep work. Text one person at lunch. Do not sacrifice focus for social needs during blocks.

Sunday Evening Ritual (30 min)

Every Sunday at 2200: 1. Review week's git log. Are you on track? 2. Update PAPER_ARCHITECTURE.md with actual word counts per section. 3. Identify next week's highest-risk task (the one most likely to fail/slip). 4. Write one paragraph of "what I learned this week" in docs/weeknotes.md. 5. Sleep 30 min earlier than usual.

This routine was designed for 49 consecutive days of high-output work. It is aggressive but physiologically sustainable if the rules are followed.